

Chapter No. 2: Forms of Worship: Al Muminoon V: 1-11

Important points of understanding

- According to the opening verse, **Faith** is a necessary condition for Falah. The word **FALAH** signifies the attainment of all desires and protection from all misfortunes. This Falah will be achieved in the here- after in the form of paradise as the verses “they are heirs; they are the heirs of paradise; They shall dwell there-in forever”, denote. Falah may be obtained by purifying oneself against sins. In the present verse Allah has promised Falah to those who possess the seven attributes.
- The **first attribute** of believers is that they are humble in prayers. The word **Khushu** **literally means** calmness, serenity of the heart and body, but **in religious terminology** it means “to bring about a state of perfect concentration in the heart” so that one does not knowingly allow any thought to enter his heart other than the remembrance of Allah. **It is an essential element for the acceptance of prayer by Allah.** It means that those things which are disliked during prayer must be avoided.
- **Another attribute** is that they turn away from vain conversations. The word Laghw (اللُّغْو) means frivolous gossips and vain things, useless talks and actions which do not bring any religious reward. Its **extreme form** includes sinful acts that are positively harmful. Its **mild form** is also absurd in the sense that it does not bring any reward but it is wastage of time. **Moreover turning away from absurd talks is an outcome or end result of those prayers which performed with due Khushu.**
- **The third attribute** highlighted in these set of verse is that they are the doers of zakat or active in deeds of charity. The word zakat is appeared with fa’eloon فَاعِلُونَ. Its means **dual meaning of zakat** is addressed here; at one end it means purification of soul from impurities such as polytheism, hypocrisy, vanity, jealousy, hatred, greed. At another end it also means giving in charity a portion of one’s wealth subject to certain prescribed condition.
- This is **also an attribute of believers** that they fulfill their physical needs according to prescribed laws of sharia and avoid unlawful liaison. فَإِنَّهُمْ غَيْرُ مَلُومِينَ which also means that the sexual desire must be kept under strict control and must not be allowed to become a means of gratification of one's passions
- **Fifth attribute** of a believer is that he should discharge his trust truly and faithfully. The word **TRUST** covers everything which a person has undertaken to perform or which has been placed under his care as trust. Since it may be of many kinds, the word is used in plural, so that it may include all sorts of trusts whether they may relate to the rights of Allah (means to perform all the injunctions and duties made obligatory by religious laws and to abstain from unlawful and undesirable things and actions) or to the rights of

Human beings (these takes numerous forms – appointment to high offices and post is trust, performance of duty is also a trust, misuse of office/authority is betrayal of trust, wealth and ability given by Allah are also a trust, other's secrets with you are a trust, any information received in confidence is a trust, mutual settlement between an employee and the employer is trust). Hence discharge of trust is an all encompassing word.

- **Sixth attribute** of a perfect Muslim is to fulfill his covenant. The word covenant has two connotations. One is a covenant between two parties specifying the duties and obligations of either party and is binding on both. And the other is where a person voluntarily promises to give something to someone or undertakes to do some job.
 - **The seventh attribute** is that they guard their prayers, consistently observe their prayers. "Guard their prayers" means to offer prayers regularly at the appointed time and the words (prayers) is plural which include all the five prayers.
 - The good Muslims who possess the attributes described above have been declared in this verse to be the heirs to the garden of paradise.
 - A careful study of the above seven attributes would show that they encompass all the duties which man owes to Allah and to fellow men, and all the laws governing those duties. A person who possesses these attributes and adheres to them is a complete mu'min (believer) and deserving of falah in this world and in the Hereafter. It will also be noted that these seven attributes begin and also end with a reference to prayers which suggests that if prayers are offered in the prescribed manner with all their requirements, the other attributes will appear automatically
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